METER CHALU

A voice coach that helps auto and taxi drivers practise Marathi, built on Gnani Prisma v3 and Timbre.

The problem

Since August 2026, Maharashtra requires every auto, taxi and app-cab driver to have working Marathi. Drivers who fail face licence suspension of up to three months, then cancellation. About 8 lakh drivers are affected, many of them Hindi-speaking migrants. The official route is a four-hour in-person class spread over about 85 days, which drivers on 12-hour shifts cannot realistically attend. The test itself is mostly spoken: conversation and reading signboards. Whatever you think of the rule, 8 lakh livelihoods now depend on passing it.

Our solution

A voice-first web app where a driver practises real Marathi conversations on their phone, at any time, in any gap between rides.

- **Role-play passengers.** Timbre speaks as a Marathi passenger across five scenarios: Dadar station, fare haggling, directions, an elderly rider, and an RTO-style practice check.
- **Speak naturally.** The driver replies by voice. Broken or mixed Hindi-Marathi is fine. Prisma v3 transcribes it and detects the language automatically.
- **Friendly scoring.** The AI judges one thing: did you get the meaning across? Not grammar. It then gives one gentle correction in Hindi, spoken back by Timbre.
- **Readiness meter.** Progress across all scenarios is tracked, so the driver knows when they feel ready.

How it works

Mic audio goes to **Gnani Prisma v3** (streaming speech-to-text, language auto-detect, Marathi place names as custom terms). The transcript goes to a fast **LLM** that plays the passenger and scores the reply. The answer is spoken by **Gnani Timbre** (Marathi voices for the passenger, a Hindi voice for the coach). **LiveKit** carries the audio in real time, with noise suppression for loud auto-stand audio.

Speed

The target is a spoken reply within 2 seconds of the driver finishing. In our first test, Prisma returned transcripts in 73 to 100 ms and Timbre's first audio arrived in about 240 ms. A built-in tracker logs every turn against the 2-second budget.

Proactive speech

The app never waits in silence. The passenger speaks first the moment a scenario starts. If the driver goes quiet for 8 seconds, the passenger gently prompts them in Marathi, with no LLM delay. When a round ends, the coach speaks up on its own with the score and one correction in Hindi.

Memory

Zep long-term memory carries each driver's progress and the phrases they struggled with from one session to the next, so practice picks up where the last one stopped.

Why it fits Gnani

- **Code-mixed speech:** drivers naturally mix Hindi and Marathi mid-sentence.
- **Regional language:** Marathi, spoken and understood end to end.
- **Noisy audio:** built for auto-stand conditions, not a quiet studio.
- **Real Deal:** a specific, timely problem with a large, clearly defined group of users.

Responsible by design

All practice is synthetic: we play the driver ourselves, with no real calls and no personal data. Meter Chalu is a practice aid. It is not official and does not certify anyone.

Built for the Great Indian AI Internship Challenge.
#GnaniAI #GreatIndianAIInternshipChallenge